

After a throwback completes, price resumes rising most of the time.

Gaps. A gap that occurs during the breakout tends to push price higher but only in bull markets. In bear markets, the results reverse with complex bottoms without gaps showing better performance.

[Table 40.5](#) shows pattern size statistics.

Height. Tall patterns perform better than short ones. I measured the height of patterns from the highest peak to the lowest valley and divided by their respective breakout prices. Values above the median saw better performance than did those below the median.

Width. Width is not as good a predictor of future performance as height. The table shows that the results vary depending on whether it's a bull or bear market. To determine whether a pattern was narrow or wide, I compared it to the median width.

Height and width combinations. The performance of the combinations of height and width tracks the results found earlier. By that, I mean bull market patterns that performed best when tall and best when wide saw the best performance if the complex bottom was both tall and wide. Similarly, bear market patterns show the best performance if they are both tall and narrow, matching their individual traits of height and width.

You'll want to avoid trading short/narrow patterns in bull markets and short/wide ones in bear markets.

[Table 40.6](#) shows volume-related statistics.

Volume trend. I found volume trends downward using linear regression on volume from the leftmost shoulder to the rightmost one.